ANALYTICS CUP

Register now!

Overview

01 The Analytics Cup Returns

MORE DATA. MORE COMMUNITY. MORE IMPACT.

The first Analytics Cup brought the open-source football analytics community together to explore SkillCorner data, develop original ideas and present six outstanding projects at the final in Paris.

The winning project, Amar Shah's **Simulated Annealing for Positional Optimisation**, has since been developed into a module within the DataballPy Python package, making the work available for the wider analytics community to use and build upon.

Now the challenge returns as **Analytics Cup 2.0**. This second edition introduces a new Basketball dataset alongside Football, plus separate Europe and USA competitions designed to bring more of the global

sports analytics community together. Both competitions will culminate in a live regional final in February 2027.

Watch the 2026 finalist presentations



Amar Shah after winning the first Analytics Cup

ANALYTICS CUP 2.0 AT A GLANCE

Two sports: Choose between Football and Basketball data, or try both.

Two regional competitions: Enter the Europe or USA edition, choose one.

Two live finals: Selected finalists will present their work in Paris or Boston to a panel of industry experts.

Up to two people per entry: Take part individually or collaborate as a pair, sign-ups are individual. Join Discord to find a partner!

CHOOSE YOUR CHALLENGE

There are no fixed tracks in Analytics Cup 2.0. We want participants to follow their curiosity and use the data to develop an original piece of analysis, research, methodology, visualisation or practical tool.

You are free to explore any question that interests you. To encourage projects with practical value for teams and practitioners, we have identified one real-world theme for each sport. Either dataset can be entered in either regional competition. Your sport does not determine your region.

Football: Defensive Positioning

How can tracking and contextual data help us better understand the way players and teams defend?

Explore team shape, spacing, pressure, compactness, marking, defensive decision-making or another question that could help analysts and coaches evaluate defensive performance.

Basketball: Shot Quality

What makes one shot better than another?

Use tracking and contextual data to explore how player positioning, defensive pressure, movement, spacing and game context influence shot selection and shot quality.

EUROPE OR USA. THE CHOICE IS YOURS.

Analytics Cup 2.0 features two separate regional competitions. The format is designed to increase participation across different time zones and create more opportunities for finalists to present their work to industry professionals in person.

Entrants can choose either competition, regardless of where they live. However, you may only enter one region and should be willing and able to travel to its regional final if selected.

Selected finalists will present their projects to a panel of industry experts, including representatives from SkillCorner, PySport, and elite Football and Basketball organisations.

EU Europe Edition

Regional final: 17 February 2027

Location: Paris, France

US USA Edition

Regional final: 24 February 2027

Location: Boston, Massachusetts

02 Datasets

Football

The Football challenge uses SkillCorner's **Australia A-League 2024/25 dataset**, providing access to multiple layers of data for analysis and research.

Basketball

The Basketball challenge uses SkillCorner's **Liga Endesa ACB dataset 2025/2026**, providing access to multiple layers of data for analysis and research.

INCLUDES:

- Season-level aggregated Dynamic Events data for shots, picks and drives from 327 games
- 10 games of XY Tracking Data
- Game Intelligence Dynamic Events for those 10 games
- Supporting documentation

Explore the Basketball data

03 Key Dates

9 Sep 2026
Challenge opens - register as an individual

18 Dec 2026
Deadline for submitting entries - submit as an individual or as a pair

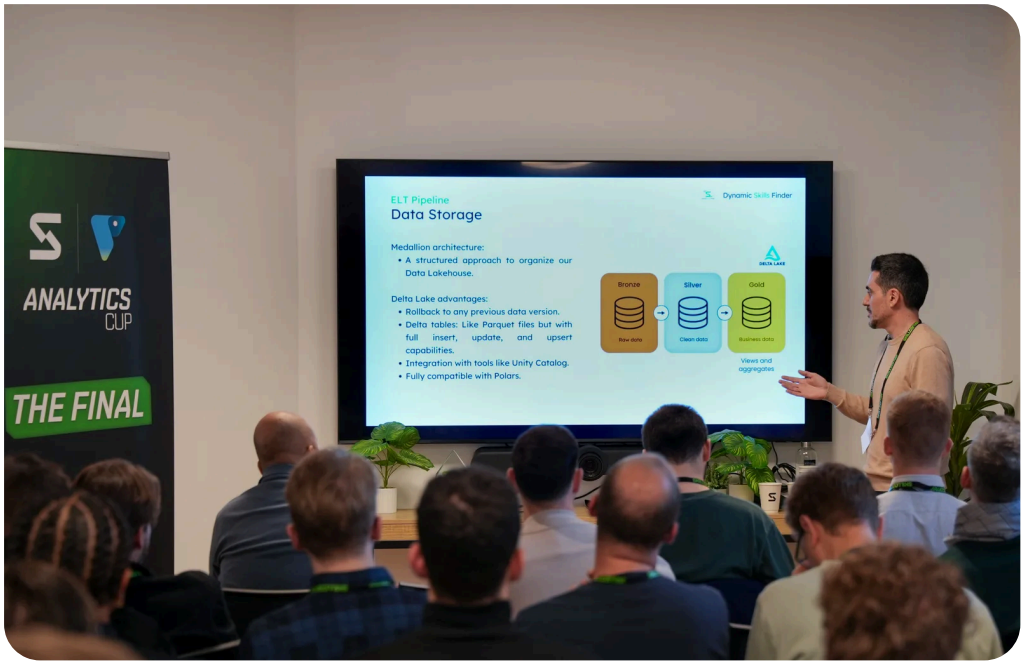
8 Jan 2027
Finalists announced

17 Feb 2027

Europe Final - Paris

24 Feb 2027

USA Final - Boston



04 Competition

THE FINAL

Analytics Cup 2.0 culminates in a live regional final. Selected finalists travel to Paris or Boston to present their projects to a panel of industry experts from football, basketball and sports analytics.

It is a chance to share your work with the people who care most about it, receive expert feedback, and connect with the broader sports analytics community.



FINALISTS AND PRIZES

The Analytics Cup is designed to reward strong ideas and help the best open-source projects create value beyond the competition.

Regional Finals

Six finalists in each region will be invited to present, in front of peers and experts, in **Paris** or **Boston**.

Reward

The six selected submissions in each region each receive **€500** (Europe) or **$500** (USA).[1]

Open Source Grant & Award

The **Regional Winners** receive a **€1,500 / $1,500** grant to support its conversion into a Python package, a functional

pull request to an existing Python package or another open-

1 One reward per submission, regardless of team size. It can be put towards travel to the regional final or spent as the recipient chooses.

2 The grant will be released when the agreed open-source deliverable is completed.

HOW TO ENTER

1. **Choose your region:** Register for either the Europe or USA competition. You cannot enter both regions.
2. **Choose your sport:** Select the Football or Basketball dataset. You may submit a separate entry using the other dataset, but it must be entered in the same region.
3. **Enter individually or as a pair:** Entries can be submitted by one person or a team of two.
4. **Build your project:** Use the data to investigate a meaningful question, develop a new method or create a practical tool. You can follow the suggested real-world theme or pursue an original idea of your own.
5. **Submit your entry:** Provide your completed project and supporting materials by 18 December 2026. Full submission requirements will be included in the competition rules.
6. **Present at the regional final:** Selected finalists will be invited to Paris or Boston to present their work live to the judging panel.

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05 Rules

ELIGIBILITY

The Analytics Cup is open to anyone worldwide, including students, independent analysts and industry professionals. Entries can be

submitted by individuals or teams of up to two people.

You must choose either the Europe or USA regional competition. You cannot enter both regions. Within your chosen region you may submit one Football entry and one Basketball entry, each as a separate submission.

Remote talks are **not** accepted. Before submitting, make sure you are able to attend the event in Boston or Paris in person. Travel and accommodation are not reimbursed, though each selected submission receives a €500 / $500 award (one per submission) that can be put towards travel costs.

> **Individuals or pairs:** individuals or teams of two people may enter. Each participant should sign up individually; submissions are made per team (or individual).
>
> **Employee restriction:** employees of SkillCorner or PySport may participate, but are not eligible for prizes or for presenting at one of the final events.

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

1. The submission must contain substantial new work created specifically for the Analytics Cup. Pre-existing libraries, frameworks, open-source projects and general-purpose code may be used, provided they are appropriately licensed and disclosed. Previously completed projects may not simply be resubmitted or lightly adapted.

2. The project must use only the SkillCorner dataset provided for this event, and/or prior Analytics Cups. The use of additional data (e.g. video, or additional matches of (SkillCorner) tracking and event data obtained outside of this competition) will lead to immediate disqualification. Finalists may receive additional SkillCorner data for Australia A-League 2024/25 dataset or Liga Endesa ACB dataset 2025/2026, under a EULA, to further their project between the finalist announcement (8 January) and the final event (17 or 24 February).

3 The submitted code and analysis must be reproducible without proprietary software (e.g. no Excel, Tableau, PowerBI).

4 **Submissions consist of:**

A YouTube video of at most one minute summarising and elevator-pitching your project, presented and voiced by you or your teammate.

A publicly available GitHub repository containing *all* resources, files and code relevant to the project (except for the data), under an open-source licence. The project should work out of the box. The repository should include a LICENSE.md file. See tldrlegal.com for more information.

A README.md file of up to 1000 words, with a maximum of two figures or tables in total, in any combination, supplementing your one-minute pitch. It must include sufficient documentation to reproduce the results, including instructions on how to run the project in a clean environment.

REVIEWING

Entries will be reviewed by a panel of experts from sports, data and open-source analytics. Strong projects will combine a clear question with thoughtful use of the available data and a result that others can understand, use or build upon.

CRITERIA

20% **Relevance** - Does the project address a meaningful sporting question or real-world problem that could help analysts, coaches or the wider sports community?

20% **Methodology** - Is the analysis technically sound, transparent and appropriate for the question?

20% **Originality** - Does it introduce a fresh idea, approach or application?

20% **Communication** - Is the work presented clearly and supported by effective evidence or visualisation?

20% **Open-source potential** - Can others reproduce, reuse or develop the work further?



OPEN SOURCE REQUIREMENTS

Analytics Cup is built around open collaboration and reproducible work. All submissions must use an open-source licence (MIT, Apache 2.0, or similar) and be submitted via a public repository. Any submitted work must remain open-source in perpetuity.

The winning entry in each region receives a grant to convert their project into a (Python) package or a functional pull request to an existing open-source package. The grant is released upon completion of the agreed deliverable.

CODE OF CONDUCT

All participants are expected to maintain professional standards throughout the competition:

- Respectful and inclusive behaviour

- No harassment, discrimination or inappropriate conduct
- Constructive feedback and collaboration
- Professional communication in all channels

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

- Participants retain ownership of their original contributions
- All submissions must use open-source licences
- SkillCorner retains rights to the provided datasets and may use submissions for promotional purposes
- By participating, you grant permission to feature your work in case studies and presentations
- Participants are responsible for ensuring they have the necessary rights and permissions to submit and open-source their work, including any permissions required from an employer, university or other third party

DISQUALIFICATION

Participants may be disqualified for:

- Violating these rules or the Code of Conduct
- Submitting plagiarised or non-original work
- Providing false information during registration
- Attempting to manipulate the reviewing process
- Late submission after the deadline
- Submitting work that does not execute or run out of the box
- Using additional data (e.g. video, or additional (SkillCorner) tracking data)

CONTACT AND SUPPORT

For questions about these rules or the competition:

Discord: sign up to receive a link to join our official Analytics Cup Discord server.

Rule clarifications and updates will be posted on the Discord server and the website.

RULE CHANGES

PySport may clarify or amend these rules where reasonably necessary. Material changes will be published on the competition website and communicated to registered participants. Changes will not be applied retroactively in a manner that unfairly disadvantages participants.

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06 Register

Thank you for submitting the form.
Check your email for further information.

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07 Resources

A non-exhaustive set of open-source tools and references to get you started. You are free to use anything else you like.

Working with the data

- kloppy - load and standardise tracking and event data
- databallpy - synchronise and analyse football tracking data

floodlight - sports data analysis toolkit

Visualisation

skillcornerviz - SkillCorner's own visualisation library

mplsoccer - football pitches and charts for matplotlib

mplbasketball - basketball courts for matplotlib

Models and methods

ML-KULeuven - research code from the KU Leuven machine learning group

Hyunsung Kim - trajectory and tracking data research

Soccer Analytics Handbook - notebooks and primers

unravelsports - graph neural networks for tracking data

Visual Exploratory Behaviour - scanning and head-orientation analysis from the U.S. Soccer Federation

Previous edition

Analytics Cup 1.0 submissions - every entry from the first edition, with code and presentations

08 FAQ

Who can enter Analytics Cup 2.0?

The competition is open to anyone worldwide, including students, independent analysts and industry professionals.

Can I enter as part of a team?

Yes. You can enter individually or as a pair. The maximum team size is two people.

Do I need to live in Europe or the USA to enter that region?

No. You can choose either regional competition regardless of where you live. You should, however, be prepared to travel to Paris or Boston if selected as a finalist.

Can I enter both regional competitions?

No. You must choose either the Europe or USA edition and submit all of your entries within that region.

Can I use both datasets?

Yes. You can submit one Football entry and one Basketball entry. Each requires a separate submission, and both must be entered in the same regional competition.

Do I have to follow the suggested theme?

No. Defensive Positioning in Football and Shot Quality in Basketball are intended to encourage work on real-world problems, but participants are free to explore another question using their chosen dataset.

Do finalists have to attend in person?

Selected finalists are expected to travel to their chosen regional final and present their work in person to the judging panel and audience of industry experts.

Is travel covered?

The top six participants in each region will receive €500 or $500, depending on their competition, which may be used to subsidise travel or spend as they choose. Participants are responsible for arranging their own travel and accommodation.

What can I submit?

Participants can create a piece of analysis, research, a new methodology, a visualisation, a practical tool or another original application of the data. The work must be new and not something previously developed for other purposes. Full technical and submission requirements will be provided in the competition rules.

How do I submit?

Submissions are made through submissions.analytics-cup.org. Please make sure you are registered before submitting.

Does my project need to be open source?

Analytics Cup is built around open collaboration and reproducible work. Full requirements covering code, licensing and public repositories will be confirmed in the competition rules.

How is the winner's Open Source Grant paid?

The winning entry in each region will receive a €1,500 / $1500 grant after the project has been converted into a Python package or a functional pull request to an existing Python package, in line with the agreed deliverable.



If you want to help us reach our goals, either by donating, hosting a meetup or contributing please reach out to us!

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ANBI Report 2025

ANBI Report 2024

Our vision doesn't say anything about a type of sports. That's by intention. We believe we should keep looking for opportunities to apply a solution from sport A to sport B. When we start being creative and think about how to apply solutions from one sport to another the

impact of those innovations is way bigger. As a result the audience is bigger and the chances are higher someone will come up with smart applications.